Bald cypress (bald-cypress)

Taxodium distichum

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Water Terrace: 4 **TOTAL 4**



Summer / form
Library candidate



Fall color
Library candidate

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 50–70 ft (landscape; to 100+ ft in wet wild sites) × 20–30 ft (pyramidal when young, broader with age)
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Hardy in USDA zones 4a–10b (commonly 5–11), including 8a and 8b. Native to southeastern United States swamps, rivers, and bottomlands, including Georgia. Tolerates wet and dry soils once established. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a.
Sun: Full sun to partial shade
Water: Prefers moist to wet; high drought tolerance once established. Tolerates extended flooding.
Soil: Good drainage to wet; acidic preferred; adapts to clay, sand, loam, slightly alkaline (chlorosis possible).
Growth rate: Moderate to moderately fast (1–2 ft per year); reaches 40–50 ft in 15–25 years.
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: (Care / planting pass): Plant at grade in full sun to partial shade in moist to wet or well-drained soils (sand, loam, clay; acidic preferred). Tolerates flooding, drought, compacted soils once established. Knees form primarily in wet sites. Little pruning required; remove dead wood or unwanted lower branches. First-year irrigation: water regularly until established; Not stated in detail beyond general establishment. Mulch depth, mound vs level, soil amendment: Not stated.
Soil prep: Good drainage to wet; acidic preferred; adapts to clay, sand, loam, slightly alkaline (chlorosis possible).
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to the southeastern U.S. from southern Delaware south to Florida, west to southeastern Texas, and inland up the Mississippi Valley to southern Illinois and Indiana. Swamps, floodplains, and stream banks. Described by Linnaeus (as Cupressus disticha) in 1753; transferred to Taxodium by Richard in 1810. [Clemson HGIC; Silvics of North America; POWO]
Form / habit: Deciduous conifer, pyramidal when young becoming broader; single trunk; long-lived (centuries). Knees in wet sites.
Foliage: Orange-red to reddish-brown / coppery-red / cinnamon-brown / yellow to copper before needle drop.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Young: reddish-brown, peeling in strips. Mature: gray to reddish-brown, fibrous, with buttressed base.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: (Health / infestation pass): None known as serious problems; resistant to pests/diseases when well-maintained. Occasional issues: cypress twig gall midge (aesthetic, galls do not harm health), bagworms, spider mites (especially in dry summers), twig blight on stressed trees, chlorosis in alkaline soils. Verticillium wilt resistant. Provide stress-free conditions.